

BOB04B22 - Anglický jazyk B2-2

WEEK 10

Listening Practice*

Key Word Sentence Transformation Practice

Vocabulary / Preposition Practice

Reading Comprehension Practice

Listening skills* are essential for comprehending lectures, which are a primary source of information in many academic settings. Students need to listen carefully to understand assignments, projects, and exam instructions. Active listening helps students identify the main ideas and supporting details of a lecture or reading, aiding in comprehension and retention.

Good listening skills enable students to follow the flow of discussions, contribute relevant points, and build upon others' ideas. Active listening is crucial for effective collaboration in group projects and discussions. Students who listen attentively are better equipped to identify areas of confusion and ask relevant questions to deepen their understanding.

Listening skills are essential for understanding presentations, engaging in meetings, and contributing to discussions in professional settings. Active listening helps individuals build rapport and establish strong relationships with colleagues and clients. Listening skills are fundamental to effective communication in any professional context.

LISTENING

You will hear a short lecture entitled 'Creating Nature.'

For each of the questions below (1 – 5), choose the answer (a, b, or c) which fits best according to what you hear. You will hear the recording twice. **CIRCLE** your answer (a, b, or c).

- (1) According to the speaker, in 1850 a trip from America to Hong Kong...
- a) ...would take four months in a sailing ship.
 - b) ...could be measured in hours.
 - c) ...would take months whereas now it would take only hours.
- (2) The way people see things depends on...
- a) ...when it is being looked at and individual experience.
 - b) ...nature.
 - c) ...whether they are children or adults.
- (3) As a result of Galileo's findings that the Moon has a rough surface...
- a) ...people were able to explore the Moon better.
 - b) ...technology began to change rapidly.
 - c) ...people began to doubt long lasting scientific ideas.
- (4) The speaker says that because of the internet humanity now has a greater knowledge of...
- a) ...science.
 - b) ...nature.
 - c) ...both science and nature.
- (5) According to the speaker...
- a) ...while nature changes around us we need to adapt to it.
 - b) ...we are connected to nature and responsible for its development.
 - c) ...the development of technology is a long process.

VOCABULARY PRACTICE:

Form used in text: Use the correct form to complete the sentences below:

- (1) ALTER A network of old tunnels was discovered by workmen making _____ to a property in the old town.
- (2) CATCH They were happy because they had _____ a lot of fish that day.
- (3) DEPEND I need someone _____ to take care of the children while I'm at work.
- (4) DRAMATICALLY The increase in the number of young people leaving to work in the cities has had a _____ impact on the demography of the villages.
- (5) NATURE Floods and earthquakes are _____ disasters.
- (6) PERCEPTION The way people _____ the real world is strongly influenced by the language they speak.
- (7) PERFECT I explained as well as I was able, given my own limited and _____ understanding of the situation.
- (8) REFLECTING She was looking at her _____ in the mirror.
- (9) RELATED Only her closest friends and _____ were invited to the wedding.
- (10) SPHERE The earth is not perfectly _____.

TIP 1

The important thing in key word transformations is that you keep the meaning **the same** – **EXACTLY the same**. So it's important that you read through the first sentence and your second sentence to ensure you have kept the meaning the same.

EXAMPLE: Tommy said he was ready for his driving test and **WOULD** take it in July.

Tommy said he was ready for his driving test and **COULD** take it in July.

One letter has been changed, from “**would**” to “**could**” but it changes the meaning of the sentence totally.

EXAMPLE: I'm sure that's not Michael Jackson, because he died a few years ago! **BE**

That **CANNOT BE HIM** because he died a few years ago.

↖ **MICHAEL JACKSON**

If the sentence to transform has names in it, the answer will have to have them too.

EXAMPLE: Nobody took **any** notice of his bad behaviour. **ATTENTION**

↑ ↓

Nobody paid **ANY ATTENTION TO** his bad behaviour.

If the sentence given has determiners in it, the answer should have to have them too.

TIP 2

Remember: the gap should be filled with **five words or fewer**. **Contractions** count as **two words**, not one.

EXAMPLE: The teacher does not let them leave the classroom during tests. **ALLOWED**

They **AREN'T ALLOWED TO LEAVE** the classroom.

↑ ↑ ↑ ↑ ↑
1 2 3 4 5
↓ ↓ ↓ ↓ ↓

They **ARE NOT ALLOWED TO LEAVE** the classroom.

TIP 3

Remember that **the word given must be included in the answer**, and cannot be altered in any way.

EXAMPLE: The drive home was too long to complete that night. **SHORT**

The drive home **WAS NOT SHORT ENOUGH** to complete that night.

The word 'short' in this example cannot be changed to 'shorter' or 'shortest'.

TIP 4

Remember that for the FEL B2 English Exam (and Erasmus Exam) **you are not to use any punctuation**.

EXAMPLE: I think it would be a good idea if you joined the beginner's class. **SUGGEST**

I **SUGGEST, THAT YOU JOIN** the beginner's class. ← **THIS ANSWER = 0 POINTS ON THE EXAM.**

↑

NO COMMA

TIP 5

If there is more than one possible answer – **write only one**.

EXAMPLE: I think it would be a good idea if you joined the beginner's class. **SUGGEST**

I **SUGGEST THAT YOU JOIN** the beginner's class. ← **THIS ANSWER = 1 POINT ON THE EXAM.**

I **SUGGEST YOU JOIN** the beginner's class. ← **THIS ANSWER = 1 POINT ON THE EXAM.**

I **SUGGEST JOINING** the beginner's class. ← **THIS ANSWER = 1 POINT ON THE EXAM.**

If you **write more than one** it **will be marked incorrect** – even if what is written is correct.

KEY WORD SENTENCE TRANSFORMATION PRACTICE**[Page 3]**

For each of the sentences below (1 - 15), complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence(s), using the word given for that sentence. **DO NOT CHANGE** the word given. You must use between two (2) and five (5) words, including the word given.

- (1) That fence is there to prevent you entering the grounds of the house. ABLE
They put the fence there, so you _____ the grounds of the house.
- (2) We were able to cross the river, despite the strong current. SUCCEEDED
We _____, despite the strong current.
- (3) I think you should say sorry for your behavior. APOLOGIZE
I think _____ your behavior.
- (4) I have a lot to do so I can't come with you to the cinema this afternoon. TOO
I _____ to be able to come to the cinema.
- (5) Does your brother have the ability to take so many exams in the same week? CAPABLE
Is _____ so many exams in the same week?
- (6) Entrance into the museum is free today. COSTS
It _____ to the museum today.
- (7) The lesson was cancelled as only three students came. UP
Only _____ the lesson, so it was cancelled.
- (8) The picnic was cancelled because of the rain. TO
The picnic was cancelled _____.
- (9) Whose bicycle is this? BELONG
Who _____ to?
- (10) She doesn't usually eat three meals a day, so she got full pretty quickly. USED
She _____ three meals a day, so she got full quickly.
- (11) You should try and take advantage of his help. MOST
You should try and _____ help he gives you.
- (12) My sister was involved in her school spelling competition. PART
My sister _____ spelling competition.
- (13) 'Why didn't you call me?' asked Joe. ASKED
Joe _____ not called him.
- (14) I don't earn anything like the amount I did before. NOWHERE
I earn _____ as I did before.
- (15) Our spending will have to be reduced next year. BACK
We will have _____ our spending next year.

PREPOSITION PRACTICE:**[Page 4]**

Complete the following sentences by filling in the blank spaces (1 - 25) with the proper preposition. Use only one word for each blank space.

- (1) The experts disagree _____ the best way of dealing with the problem.
- (2) People who work in banks know _____ finance.
- (3) She is a big fan _____ reggae music and the late Bob Marley.
- (4) The decisions we take now may influence the course _____ events in the future.
- (5) It's an issue we'll have to confront _____ some point, no matter how unpleasant it is.
- (6) The statistics seriously underestimate the number _____ people affected.
- (7) We've all been speculating _____ the mysterious man who moved into the house two doors down.
- (8) The drug will be useful _____ hundreds of thousands of infected people.
- (9) He studied these subjects _____ his own.
- (10) The paintings of Paul Cezanne prefigured the rise _____ cubism in the early 20th century.
- (11) The Romantic repeatedly told us that we create nature _____ dreaming nature.
- (12) Technology is the factor that most rapidly and dramatically changes what we see when we look _____ nature.
- (13) Now the Internet pours new images and information _____ our lives.
- (14) There has been an increase _____ the number of young people leaving rural areas to work in cities.
- (15) Cars are useful, but their impact _____ the environment is another matter altogether.
- (16) The way people view the world is strongly influenced _____ the language they speak.
- (17) She was looking _____ her reflection.
- (18) She could see her reflection _____ the mirror.
- (19) The publishers planned to produce the journal _____ a weekly basis.
- (20) He was looking forward _____ working with the new Prime Minister.
- (21) I have ten years' experience _____ the senior management level.
- (22) Students account _____ the vast majority of our customers.
- (23) Japanese people, _____ average, live longer than Europeans.
- (24) They are working towards a solution _____ their problems.
- (25) Most single-parent families are headed _____ women.

READING COMPREHENSION

[Page 5]

Read the following passage - then choose the best answer (a, b, c, d or e) for each of the questions (1 - 8).

English Ivy **betrays** its poor reputation as a nuisance by its unparalleled ability to provide shade. By seamlessly covering the exterior of a building, it works as a natural insulator, blocking the sun and decreasing air conditioning costs. This means big savings for both building tenants and homeowners alike. And it can happen quickly, too. Under the proper conditions, established English Ivy can grow to cover an area of roughly 500 square feet per year. Given that most homes have a roof measuring roughly 2000 square feet, ivy-friendly homeowners can rest assured that their roofs will be completely covered in about four years. When considering growth rates of newly planted ivy, just remember the old adage: First year, it sleeps. Second year, it creeps. Third year, it leaps! For English Ivy, this is especially true.

Now, detractors may take this opportunity to remind readers about how invasive English Ivy can be. For what ivy enthusiast hasn't been cautioned about its ability to burrow holes, fracture windows, and even **deteriorate** brick? But be warned. Oftentimes, this suggestion is taken to the comical extreme. Naysayers take a strange pleasure in spinning yarns about a particularly **malevolent** strand of ivy—one that slips in through the cracks on a hot summer night, silently strangling homeowners in their sleep.

Admittedly, this can be a funny story to tell. But are we to believe such a tale? The intelligent gardener will quickly dismiss such rubbish for what it is.

(1) The primary purpose of the passage is to...

- a) ...highlight the reasons why English Ivy's fast growth rate is beneficial.
- b) ...argue that English Ivy is an essential plant for homeowners.
- c) ...educate readers about how to use English Ivy to insulate their homes.
- d) ...belittle detractors of English Ivy.
- e) ...defend the reputation of English Ivy.

(2) As used in paragraph 1, which is the best definition for **betrays**?

- a) gives away
- b) contradicts
- c) reveals
- d) supports
- e) highlights

(3) In paragraph 1, the author states, "Given that most homes have a roof measuring roughly 2000 square feet, ivy-friendly homeowners can rest assured that their roofs will be completely covered in about four years."

Which of the following logical mistakes does the author make in drawing this conclusion?

- I. English Ivy will not cover the area of most roofs in 4 years if it only grows 500 square feet per year.
- II. Most homes may not have the proper conditions necessary for English Ivy to grow at the specified rate.
- III. Newly planted ivy does not grow as fast as established ivy.

- a) I only
- b) II only
- c) I and II only
- d) II and III only
- e) I, II, and III

(4) As used in paragraph 2, which is the best definition for **deteriorate**?

- a) wear away
- b) shield
- c) add to
- d) climb on
- e) strengthen

(5) Based on information in paragraph 1, which of the following would most likely be considered an insulator?

- a) an umbrella
- b) an automobile
- c) suntan lotion
- d) skin
- e) a winter jacket

(6) As used in paragraph 2, which is the best antonym for **malevolent**?

- a) wary
- b) sensitive
- c) virtuous
- d) injured
- e) willing

(7) This passage would most likely be found...

- a) ...in a scholarly journal about botany.
- b) ...in a magazine article about gardening.
- c) ...in a letter from one gardener to another.
- d) ...on a website identifying different types of plants.
- e) ...in a pamphlet about the best ways to make a home more energy efficient.

(8) The author's tone can best be described as:

- a) passionate
- b) indignant
- c) argumentative
- d) persuasive
- e) accusatory